



iOmega Screenplay DX 1 TB

Price: ₹12,999

HD Media Players

Today, given the availability of huge storage options, the practice of accumulating multi-media content is growing rapidly. People have started archiving their favourite movies, music, images and all other possible sorts of media content. And with the advent of HDTV's, a strong desire to enjoy all the archived media content in HD glory has increased. The market demanded a device that could take all the stored media content and play them in HD clarity; HD media players were thus born. We have seen a flurry of HD media players especially in the past one year, as the manufacturers try to pip each other. It is amazing to see how the HD media player market has evolved in the recent past. From the initial HD media players that couldn't support all formats of media - to those that could - then to those that incorporated all the networking abilities and to now, where the players possess all of the above features with a fat storage device built-in. The UI of most HD media players still is difficult to use, the upscaling quality on many players needs improvement, a few formats still remain unsupported. However, having said that, the HD media player manufacturers are headed in the right direction, and how these the products will evolve is something the year 2012 will answer.



DLNA certification

DLNA has finally become a standard protocol among smart products. You can now stream all your mobile or pc content to any DLNA certified device and vice versa.



D-Link's Boxee Box

The recently released D-Link's Boxee Box is a media streamer that lets you find TV programs from the internet and deliver it to your TV. In the coming year, you will find a lot of companies launching Boxee based devices.



LG Smart TV

If you thought HD TV's were the next big thing, then probably you haven't heard of Smart TV's. LG and Samsung have already launched their Smart TV's in the market and are now pressing developers for new applications for them.



WD Live TV HUB 1 TB

It has by far the simplest User Interface yet and it also delivers fantastic upscaling performance.

Price: ₹11,990



Asus O! Play HDP R1

The Asus O! Play HDP R1 delivers excellent upscaling performance and is budget friendly.

Price: ₹5,465

Zero1 Winner

This year the Zero1 award goes to the iOmega Screenplay DX 1 TB. With 1TB of in-built storage, easy to use XMB- styled UI and excellent performance, it's one of the best HD media players available today. But what truly makes this HD media player a winner is the QWERTY keyboard sporting unique remote that the player comes with. The remote is nothing like what we have seen on a media player before. It not only made the navigation a breeze, but also gave us an amazing web-browsing experience. The only disappointment we had with the device was the UI albeit easy to use, it lacks aesthetics.

Worthy Mentions

Not far behind are media players one each from Asus and Western Digital. The **Asus O! Play HDP R1**, not only delivers amazing performance but also is extremely budget friendly. The **WD Live TV Hub 1 TB** on the other hand has the best UI among all the HD media players today. It also delivers a fantastic upscaling performance.